

Robert Farrow

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Medium 

This CV 

Professional Experience

2024 Nov - Present

-  Java
-  Spring Boot
-  Apache Flink
-  Kafka
-  Elasticsearch
-  Kubernetes
-  Argo CD
-  Jenkins
-  AWS
-  Claude / LLMs

Visa - Senior Engineering Manager

- Lead two engineering teams within VXBS (Visa Cross-Border Solutions): the Real-Time Data Platform (RTDP) team, driving event-driven architecture across the platform, and the Treasury Liquidity Management (TRLM) team, rebuilding the core treasury system.
- Founded and run the internal Claude Guild — a cross-team practice of 300+ engineers with monthly demo sessions topping 150 attendees — driving adoption of the latest from Claude, lifting engineering productivity and embedding safe, effective LLM use across VXBS.
- Led the team through our eventification / event-driven architecture pivot, taking Apache Flink from zero to production as the streaming backbone for VXBS — re-architected an external-facing API on top of Flink and Elasticsearch to cut p99 latency, with further rollout ongoing.
- Operate within a regulated Java / Spring Boot stack under strict security controls, delivering services to 5 nines of availability through fully automated Argo CD and Jenkins pipelines.
- Balance hands-on technical leadership with people management — setting direction, unblocking engineers and owning outcomes, while staying close enough to the stack to make credible technical and architectural decisions.

2022 Nov - 2024 Nov

-  Terraform
-  Python
-  SQL
-  Serverless λ
-  TypeScript
-  Go
-  Spark
-  Docker
-  dbt
-  Snowflake
-  Azure
-  GCP

Profusion - Head of Engineering

- Led and managed the engineering team end-to-end — hiring, onboarding, performance managing and making the hard calls rather than the easy ones.
- Owned engineering budgets and accounting structure, driving the transition from a loss-making unit to the leading revenue generator for the business.
- Designed and rolled out a utilisation model to identify and fix pipeline inefficiencies, upskilling project management on the process and sustaining the 70%+ billable zone needed for consultancy profitability.
- Set strategic direction — technology choices, cross-skilling for resilience, AWS partnership — while fostering a continuous-learning culture; communicated direction internally and externally via blog posts such as [the machine that builds the machine](#).
- Built a reusable Terraform IAC framework for AWS account management — VPC, VPN, IAM, budgeting, alerting and endpoint management — underpinning a new multi-client, multi-account delivery model.

2019 Aug - 2022 Nov

-  EMR
-  Lambda
-  Appmesh
-  Looker

HTK - Full Stack Data Engineer

- Engineered [Autopilot](#), a machine-learning product ingesting real-time horizon data and automatically surfacing insights such as churn and anomaly detection.
- Led a small, cohesive team of developers, QA and data scientists to deliver Autopilot to production.
- Architected the fully decoupled, well-documented infrastructure (EMR, SFN, Lambda, ECS, Appmesh, Athena, Looker, SageMaker, RDS) and established the Jenkins-based CI/CD architecture for immediate failure detection.